

PREFACE

We are living through a transformation most people feel long before they can name it.

A thinning of experience.

A soft unreality.

A sense that life has become slightly synthetic around the edges — smoother, flatter, less grounded.

This is not a moral failing or a personal weakness.

It is the predictable consequence of living in environments that accelerate faster than minds can compress.

When entropy outruns coherence, reality drifts.

People describe it as burnout, or numbness, or dissociation.

But the deeper pattern is not psychological.

It is structural.

It emerges from the way information flows, how culture compresses, how identity adapts, and how AI reshapes the boundaries of human cognition.

This book is not a warning.

It is a lens.

Reality Drift is the name for the hidden forces hollowing out experience in the modern world — and the map that makes those forces understandable.

It explains why everything feels *real-ish*, why communication keeps missing, why identity feels less stable, why attention feels thin, and why time no longer holds its weight.

But it also explains why none of this means we are lost.

Once you can see the Drift, you can navigate it.

Once you understand the systems shaping your mind, you regain the ability to shape your mind back.

This book is for anyone who still feels human in a world that keeps trying to turn them into something else.

— A. Jacobs

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